

CLASS 12

English

NARRATIVE STYLE-Narrative style refers to the specific way an author tells a story, using techniques to shape characters, settings, and events.

1. Descriptive Narrative Style

Uses vivid language to create strong images of settings, characters, and emotions.

- **Examples:**
 - In "*A Thing of Beauty*" (Flamingo), detailed descriptions of nature like "the sun, the moon, trees old and young" evoke peace and solace.
 - In "*My Mother at Sixty-Six*" (Flamingo), Kamala Das describes her mother's "ashen face, like that of a corpse," portraying the emotional impact of aging.
 - "*The Tiger King*" (Vistas) exaggerates the king's personality and quest to kill tigers, enhancing the satire and humor.

2. Linear Narrative Style

Definition: Presents events in a chronological order from beginning to end.

- **Examples:**
 - "*Deep Water*" (Flamingo) follows Douglas's journey from fear to courage in a clear, sequential manner.
 - In "*The Enemy*" (Vistas), the story progresses linearly, from Dr. Sadao's discovery of the wounded soldier to his decision to help him escape.
 - "*Lost Spring*" (Flamingo) presents the lives of street children in a straightforward way, emphasizing their harsh realities.

3. Nonlinear Narrative Style

Definition: Events do not follow a straightforward timeline; includes flashbacks or shifts in time.

- **Examples:**
 - "*The Rattrap*" (Flamingo) uses reflections and realizations about the past to add depth to the peddler's journey.
 - In "*The Third Level*" (Vistas), the narrative shifts between Charley's present life and his mysterious experience at the "third level," creating ambiguity.
 - "*Memories of Childhood*" (Vistas) includes flashbacks as the authors recount impactful childhood memories tied to larger cultural themes.

4. Viewpoint Narrative Style

Definition: The story is told from a specific point of view, offering insight into the narrator's thoughts and emotions.

- **Examples:**
 - In "*Aunt Jennifer's Tigers*" (Flamingo), the third-person viewpoint focuses on Aunt Jennifer's inner struggles, symbolized through the fearless tigers.
 - "*Indigo*" (Flamingo) uses first-person narration, giving a personal perspective on Gandhi's influence and dedication to justice.

NARRATIVE TECHNIQUES

A narrative technique is any of several storytelling methods the creator of a text uses, thus effectively relaying information to the audience or making the story more complete, complex, or engaging.

1. Character

- **Definition:** The individuals in a story who drive the plot and embody specific traits, beliefs, or values.
- **Example:** In "*The Enemy*" (Vistas), Dr. Sadao's inner conflict between his duty as a doctor and his loyalty to his country brings complexity to his character.

2. Perspective

- **Definition:** The point of view from which the story is told, shaping how readers perceive events.
- **Example:** "*Lost Spring*" (Flamingo) uses a third-person perspective with authorial reflections, providing insights into the harsh realities of child labor.

3. Plot

- **Definition:** The sequence of events that form the story's structure.
- **Example:** "*The Rattrap*" (Flamingo) follows a linear plot, moving from the peddler's hardships to his eventual redemption through an act of kindness.

4. Setting

- **Definition:** The time, place, and environment where the story unfolds, often influencing mood and character actions.
- **Example:** In "*Deep Water*" (Flamingo), the swimming pool setting intensifies Douglas's fear of water and later becomes a place of triumph.

5. Style

- **Definition:** The author's unique use of language, tone, and structure.

- **Example:** In "*My Mother at Sixty-Six*" (Flamingo), Kamala Das's simple, flowing style reflects the poem's deep, personal exploration of aging and separation.

6. Theme

- **Definition:** The central message or idea of the story, often exploring moral or social issues.
 - **Example:** "*A Thing of Beauty*" (Flamingo) explores the theme of finding joy and hope in nature, suggesting that beauty provides solace amid life's challenges.
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Additional Techniques with Examples

1. Foreshadowing

- **Definition:** Hints about what will happen later, building suspense or preparing readers for future events.
- **Example:** In "*The Last Lesson*" (Flamingo), Franz's reluctance to attend school hints at the regret he'll feel when he learns it's his last French lesson.

2. Flashback

- **Definition:** A shift to past events to provide background or context to the current situation.
- **Example:** In "*Deep Water*" (Flamingo), Douglas recalls his earlier near-drowning incident, explaining his intense fear of water.

3. Irony

- **Definition:** A contrast between expectations and reality, often highlighting a deeper truth or humor.
- **Example:** In "*The Tiger King*" (Vistas), the king's obsessive effort to avoid his fate ironically leads to his death, emphasizing the futility of escaping destiny.

4. Symbolism

- **Definition:** Using symbols (objects, characters, or events) to represent larger ideas or themes.
- **Example:** In "*The Rattrap*" (Flamingo), the rattrap symbolizes the trap of materialism and greed, showing how people are ensnared by worldly desires.

5. Imagery

- **Definition:** Descriptive language that appeals to the senses, creating vivid pictures.
- **Example:** "*Keeping Quiet*" (Flamingo) uses imagery of nature and silence to depict peace and introspection.

6. Hyperbole

- **Definition:** Exaggeration for emphasis or effect, often to highlight an idea or add humor.
- **Example:** In "*The Tiger King*" (Vistas), the king's decree to kill a hundred tigers is an exaggerated measure that emphasizes his arrogance.

7. Epiphany

- **Definition:** A sudden realization by a character, often changing their perspective.
- **Example:** In "*The Rattrap*" (Flamingo), the peddler has an epiphany about kindness and generosity after his encounter with the ironmaster's daughter, leading to a change in his ways.

8. Cliffhanger

- **Definition:** Ending a section or chapter with unresolved suspense, keeping readers engaged.
- **Example:** The ending of "*The Third Level*" (Vistas) leaves readers questioning the reality of Charley's experience, maintaining intrigue about the mysterious third level.

9. Red Herring

- **Definition:** A misleading clue or distraction that diverts attention from the main plot.

Examples

- On the Face of It (Vistas): Mr. Lamb's cheerful and philosophical outlook on life seems to suggest he has fully embraced his condition. This is a red herring, as the story subtly reveals his loneliness and tragic end, emphasizing the emotional scars that linger behind physical appearances.
- In "*The Enemy*" (Vistas), the fear of spies and the threat posed by the American soldier act as red herrings, heightening tension.
- The Tiger King" (**Vistas**): The King's obsession with killing 100 tigers is a red herring. While it seems central to the plot, it ultimately distracts from the irony that his death is caused by a trivial wooden toy tiger, underscoring the futility of his actions.

10. Repetition

- **Definition:** Repeating words, phrases, or ideas to emphasize a point or theme.
- **Example:** In "*Aunt Jennifer's Tigers*" (Flamingo), the repetition of "tigers" symbolizes strength and freedom, contrasting Aunt Jennifer's oppression.

11. Narrative Hook

- **Definition:** An engaging beginning that grabs the reader's attention, encouraging them to keep reading.
- **Example:** The opening line of "*The Third Level*" (Vistas) immediately hooks readers with Charley's discovery of a third level, hinting at a mysterious and intriguing plot.

These narrative techniques add depth and engagement to text helping readers connect with themes, characters, and messages. Each technique contributes uniquely, enhancing the emotional impact and thematic richness of each story.